

Beginning With C++

2.1 Introduction To C++

During the sixties, the rapid development on computers led to the evolution of several new programming languages. Among all, Algol 60, was developed as an alternative to Fortran. Algol 68 developed during this period, directly influenced the data types used in C. However, being a non specific language, it was not very popular in solving commercial tasks.

In 1963, Combined Programming language (CPL) evolved, and was more efficient in addressing concrete programming tasks as compared to Algol and Fortran. However, this was rather bulkier, and difficult to learn and implement. Four years later, in 1967, Martin Richards developed the Basic Combined Programming Language (BCPL). This was a simplified version of CPL, but was extremely abstract.

In 1970, Ken Thompson started developing UNIX at the Bell Labs and created B. It proved to be an effective simplification of CPL. Unfortunately, B too, had limitations. It compiled to a threaded, rather than executable code, thereby generating a slower code during program execution. Therefore, it was inadequate for the development of an operating system. In such an environment, Dennis Ritchie started the development of a B compiler in 1971, which was able to directly generate executable code. The resulting language was named “New B”, and finally known as the “C” language.

Ritchie developed the basic structure for C in 1973. Several concepts such as arrays and pointers were incorporated in this new language, without being transformed into a high-level language.

Bjarne Stroustrup, also from Bell Labs, began development work of C++ in 1980, and published the first manual in 1985. The